



Stop it, Mom!

Study suggests that teenagers aren't as cooperative when mothers used a stern voice to ask them to study. <https://digit.in/oct19-77>



More vaping illnesses

The CDC has stated that there have been an alarming increase in vaping-related illnesses in the US. <https://digit.in/oct19-78>

HP Chromebook X360 (14-da0003tu)

A capable battery-powered Chrome browser in a classy casing

In the past we've seen Chromebook models from brands such as HP, Acer, and Samsung but none of them have ever really taken off. None of these brands have ever reported a remarkable Chromebook success story in India. This is in part due to the high selling price of these machines and in part due to users wanting more from their laptop, like support for Windows apps. HP, however, is confident that it's time for the Chromebook to make a splash. The one here is priced at ₹44,990 for the Core i3 variant and ₹52,990 for the Core i5 variant. On the face of it, that price looks arguably steep. But can a modern, updated Chromebook in 2019 like HP's latest offering pull it off?

Design

The HP Chromebook x360 sports a 14-inch WLED-backlit touchscreen display with a Full HD resolution. Sound from the HP Chromebook x360's top-firing speaker strip is loud and clear for casual music listening but nothing more. Highs and mids make it through quite clearly but lows suffer a bit. The HP Chromebook x360 is blessed with most of the essential ports on either side of its body. On the left side, there's a USB-C 3.1 port, a 3.5mm audio jack for headsets, and a microSD card slot. On the right side, there's another USB-C 3.1 port, a USB-A 3.1 port, and a Kensington lock slot. The power button and volume rocker also find themselves on the sides of the laptop's body.

Usability

Like all modern Chromebooks, the HP Chromebook x360 runs Chrome OS, which is essentially Google's proprietary PC operating system built around its popular Chrome browser. Apart from the obvious browser application, Chrome OS comes with very few fea-



Price
₹44,990

tures or components, a fact that is key to its speed and simplicity. There is, however, an inbuilt file manager, which can be integrated with Google Drive and Dropbox but not Microsoft OneDrive (at least not easily).

In recent times Chrome OS has received support for Android and Linux apps, which is something we believe can make a big difference in the way the Chromebook is perceived now in India, the new HP offering included. A shortcut to the Google Play Store is seen on the taskbar (or shelf, as Google calls it) right after setup. Android apps install and run on Chrome OS just the way they do on an Android smartphone.

Chrome OS is fairly easy to get used to whether you're a user of MacOS or Windows. The HP Chromebook x360 is easy to use as a laptop but a bit difficult to use as a tablet. This is mostly because it feels quite heavy in the hands; the device weighs 1.68 kilogrammes. Also, the touchscreen displays a bit of latency, so taps and swipes have to be repeated sometimes. It's a shame the HP Active Pen stylus doesn't come bundled with the device.

Performance

The Chromebook x360 review unit proved to be a reliable and convenient companion for daily productivity work. We had practically zero

problems using the review unit for composing emails and documents, browsing the web, playing music in the background, watching videos, etc. We were able to switch between thirty-odd tabs on Chrome without noticing any signs of lag or stuttering. Occasionally we would notice a hiccup in the animation while switching between virtual desktops but it was never anything off-putting in the long run.

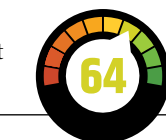
A cold boot on the Chromebook x360 happens in under ten seconds and an average-size PDF file (1.5-2MB) opens in under two seconds, which is impressive to say the least. Windows 10-powered laptops in the same price

range usually take three times longer to boot to desktop mostly because they employ a sluggish hard drive. So, if quick browsing is the main reason you're buying a new laptop, the HP Chromebook x360 fits that bill perfectly. Despite the one-year subscription to Google One (which entitles a user to 100GB of extra space on Google Drive), we feel the Chromebook x360 could have come with a larger storage drive.

Verdict

If you're in the market for a premium convertible laptop that can run the Chrome browser really well for long hours on battery life, the HP Chromebook x360 is the one you should really consider.

—Vignesh Giridharan



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SPECIFICATIONS

OS: ChromeOS | CPU: Intel Core i3-8130U | RAM: 8 GB DDR4-2133 | ROM: 64 GB eMMC | GRAPHICS: Intel HD Graphics 620 | DISPLAY: 14-inch IPS FHD | Wi-Fi: 802.11 ac | BLUETOOTH: 4.2 | BATTERY: 60 Wh | WARRANTY: 1 year.

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